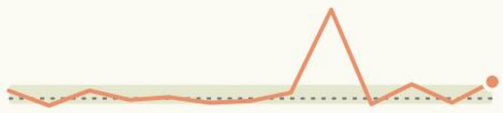
41 PRs merged in a busier-than-usual week on the road to 33.0

PRs merged
41 ▲ +26%

typical 32.5 · 13 weeks

Human reviewers
75 ▼ -1%

typical 76 · 13 weeks

Median time-to-merge
14 d ▲ +139%

typical 5.8d · 13 weeks

First-time contributors
2 ▼ -0.5

typical 2.5 · 13 weeks

WHAT HAPPENED — FROM THE WEEK'S PRS, DELVING & MAILING LIST

P2P Network Hardening

Recent merges significantly bolster the P2P layer's resilience and security, including uniform address sampling within addrman buckets to improve decentralization, stricter enforcement against invalid compact blocks, and capping maximum connections to enhance node stability.

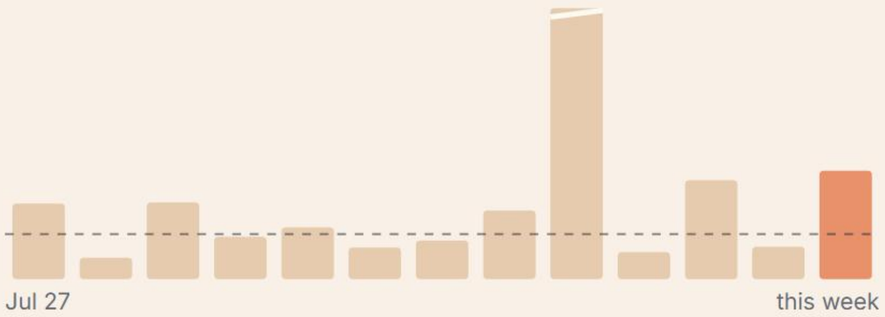
Addressing NAT Traversal for Decentralization

Active discussions around TCP hole punching indicate a critical focus on enabling better connectivity for nodes behind home NATs, which could represent a major technical shift towards improving network decentralization and inbound connection availability.

WELCOME First PR merged: Bruce039, Kevin Ravensberg

SIGNAL OF THE WEEK

Merges took longer: 14d median time-to-merge, 139% above the 8-week typical of 5.85d.



13 weeks · dashed line = typical (median of the previous 8 weeks)

RELEASE **Bitcoin Core 33.0** · In development — 10/21 milestone PRs closed

14 of 41 merges changed behaviour; P2P & Network drew the most review

MERGES THAT MATTER

PRODUCT AREAS FIRST · BY HUMAN REVIEW

#36449 addrman: use uniform sampling inside buckets

Improves the address manager's peer selection logic by ensuring more uniform sampling within its buckets.

P2P & Network · NETWORK & PRIVACY · **29** review comments · **7** ACKs · by Pieter Wuille

#35461 util: Clarify the assertion message in assertion failures (Assert, Assume, etc.)

Enhances the utility functions responsible for assertions (like Assert and Assume) by clarifying the messages displayed during assertion failures.

Node & Storage · MAINTENANCE & TECH DEBT · **22** review comments · **2** ACKs · by optout21

#35321 p2p: Misbehave on invalid compact block in optimistic reconstruction

Enhances network security by introducing a 'misbehavior' penalty for peers that send invalid compact blocks during optimistic reconstruction.

P2P & Network · SECURITY & CONSENSUS · **18** review comments · **3** ACKs · by Vinicius Cestari

#35919 p2p: cap maxconnections at 2,000 to reduce crash risk

Implements a hard cap of 2,000 on the maximum number of peer connections a node can establish.

P2P & Network · SECURITY & CONSENSUS · **17** review comments · **6** ACKs · by Lorinc Pap

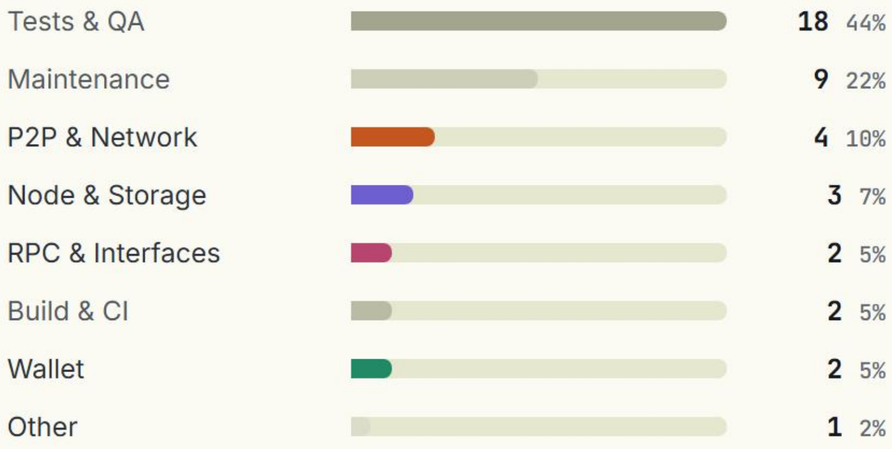
#36581 subprocess: fix command line memory leak on Windows

Addresses a memory leak issue on Windows when Bitcoin Core interacts with external processes.

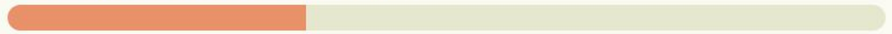
Node & Storage · PERFORMANCE & OPTIMIZATION · **14** review comments · **4** ACKs · by stickies-v

WHERE THE WORK LANDED

41 MERGES



BEHAVIOUR CHANGE VS UPKEEP



14 changed behaviour · 27 maintenance

MOST ACTIVE REVIEWERS

Reproducibility Matters 50 · **MarcoFalke** 50 · **Hennadii Stepanov** 45 · **Ferdinando M. Ametrano** 36 · **Michael Ford** 36

Where a careful review helps most this week

NEARLY THERE

OPEN · 2+ ACKS

#36586 coins: warn of low disk space before chainstate compaction

Node & Storage **2** ACKs · **10** review comments this week

#36525 mining: add getTotalFees(), protect m_block_template with mutex

Mining **3** ACKs · **9** review comments this week

#35642 headersync: do parameter search at runtime

Other **3** ACKs · **5** review comments this week

33.0 MILESTONE

NEEDS REVIEW

#29843 policy: Allow non-standard scripts with -acceptnonstdtxn=1 (test nets only)

#30951 net: option to disallow v1 connection on ipv4 and ipv6 peers

#31507 build: Use clang-cl to build on Windows natively

FROM THE DEV MEETING

OCT 22

Review #36608: Private Broadcast Rework.

Developers: Review instagibbs's PR #36608.

MOST ACTIVE PROTOCOL DISCUSSIONS

DELVING BITCOIN · BITCOINDEV MAILING LIST

DELVING TCP hole punching for Bitcoin nodes behind home NATs?

Developers are actively discussing methods to increase the number of reachable Bitcoin nodes, particularly for home use...

9 messages this week

DELVING Best critiques of BIP300/drivechains?

Community members are seeking to understand and critically evaluate alternative blockchain scaling and feature proposal...

3 messages this week

DELVING Several projects to make merchant adoption easier and cheaper

Developers are working to simplify merchant onboarding, especially for Lightning payments, by ensuring reliable payment...

3 messages this week

DELVING Cost-Bounded Transaction Filtering Language

A new feature allows Bitcoin node operators to precisely control which types of transactions their node processes.

2 messages this week